

54 Articles

Articles are some of the shortest and most common words in the English language. There are several rules stating which article, if any, should be used.

 **New language** Articles

Aa Vocabulary Commonly misspelled words

 **New skill** Saying words with silent letters

54.1 KEY LANGUAGE THE DEFINITE ARTICLE

Use the definite article "the" when the person or thing you are referring to is easily identifiable.

**We went on a tour and
the guide was excellent.**

It is clear from the context that this means the tour guide.



This includes situations where a person or thing has already been mentioned.

**There's a bus trip or a lecture.
I'd prefer the bus trip.**

The bus trip has already been mentioned.



Use the definite article before superlatives.

**The Colosseum is probably
the most famous site in Rome.**

The definite article is used before superlatives such as "most famous."



The definite article is also used with unique objects.

**I'm going to the Trevi Fountain
before I check out.**

The Trevi Fountain is a unique object.



It is also used for people with unique titles.

**The Pope is visiting another
country this week.**

"Pope" is a title.



54.2 KEY LANGUAGE THE INDEFINITE ARTICLE

Use the indefinite articles "a" and "an" when the exact person or thing you are referring to is unknown.

We are trying to choose a vacation.

The vacation is a new thing that is being introduced.



Also use the indefinite article to talk about an entire class of people or things generally.

India is a fascinating country to visit.

